

LUSAKA SCHOOL OF NURSING

CLASS TRIAL PLAN

NAME OF STUDENT:	—	INDEX	—
COURSE NAME:	Integrated Reproductive Health II	NUMBER:	—
TOPIC:	Postpartum Care and Maternal Health -	PROGRAMME:	Diploma in Nursing -
VENUE:	Immediate Postpartum Period - Physical and	DATE:	Year 2 Semester 2
DURATION:	Emotional Changes	TIME:	—
METHOD OF	—	NUMBER OF	—
INSTRUCTION:	—	STUDENTS:	—
NAME OF	—	MEDIA:	—
SUPERVISOR:	—	SIGNATURE:	—

INTRODUCTION

The postpartum period, also known as the puerperium, is a period of time after childbirth. This lesson will explore the physiological changes that occur during the postpartum period (first 24 hours after delivery) and the outcomes.

Understanding postpartum care is essential for preventing infection, and maternal mental health.

GENERAL OBJECTIVES

At the end of the lesson, the student will be able to:

1. Describe the physiological changes that occur during the postpartum period
2. Identify signs and symptoms of postpartum complications
3. Demonstrate appropriate nursing interventions for postpartum complications
4. Explain the importance of early postpartum care
5. Discuss strategies for preventing postpartum complications

LEARNING OUTCOMES

1. Perform a comprehensive postpartum assessment and evaluation
2. Recognize early warning signs of postpartum complications
3. Provide evidence-based education to the postpartum woman
4. Support mothers in initiating and maintaining breastfeeding
5. Document postpartum care according to the nursing process

KEY DEFINITIONS AND DESCRIPTIONS

1. Puerperium: The 6-week period after childbirth during which the woman returns to her non-pregnant state
2. Involution: The process by which the uterus returns to its normal size and position

3. Lochia: Vaginal discharge following childbirth, consisting of blood, mucus, and uterine tissue
4. Fundus: The upper portion of the uterus, assessed to monitor uterine involution
5. Postpartum Hemorrhage (PPH): Blood loss exceeding 500ml after vaginal delivery or 1000ml after cesarean section

LESSON PRESENTATION

TIME	SPECIFIC OBJECTIVE	CONTENT	TEACHER'S ACTIVITY	STUDENT'S ACTIVITY	TEACHING/ LEARNING RESOURCES	EVALUATION
10 min	Introduce the topic and establish learning context	Overview of postpartum period and its significance in maternal health	Present statistics on maternal mortality related to postpartum complications. Use case study to illustrate importance.	Listen actively, take notes, share prior knowledge or experiences	PowerPoint slides, case study handout	Ask students to identify key risk factors from case study
20 min	Describe physiological changes in immediate postpartum period	Uterine involution, cardiovascular changes, hormonal shifts, lochia progression	Explain physiological processes using diagrams. Demonstrate fundal height assessment on model.	Observe demonstration, ask clarifying questions, practice on models in pairs	Anatomical models, diagrams, demonstration supplies	Students demonstrate correct fundal palpation technique
25 min	Identify signs and symptoms of postpartum complications	Postpartum hemorrhage, infection, thromboembolism, hypertensive disorders	Present clinical scenarios. Facilitate group discussion on warning signs. Show video of emergency response.	Participate in group discussion, analyze scenarios, identify red flags	Clinical scenario cards, video clips, emergency protocol charts	Groups present their analysis of assigned scenarios
20 min	Perform comprehensive postpartum assessment	Vital signs, fundal assessment, lochia evaluation, perineal inspection, emotional status	Demonstrate complete postpartum assessment. Guide students through assessment checklist.	Practice assessment skills on simulation mannequin, complete assessment checklist	Simulation mannequin, assessment forms, vital signs equipment	Observe student performance using checklist, provide feedback
15 min	Explain importance of early bonding and breastfeeding	Skin-to-skin contact, breastfeeding initiation, benefits for mother and baby	Present evidence on benefits of early bonding. Show video of proper latch technique.	Watch video, discuss cultural practices, role-play patient education	Video on breastfeeding, breastfeeding models, educational pamphlets	Students demonstrate teaching points for breastfeeding initiation
20 min	Discuss prevention strategies for postpartum hemorrhage	Active management of third stage, uterotonic medications, monitoring protocols	Explain AMTSL protocol. Discuss medication administration and monitoring.	Take notes, ask questions, review medication cards	AMTSL protocol guidelines, medication reference cards	Quiz on AMTSL steps and medication dosages
10 min	Summarize key learning points and address questions	Review of main concepts, clarification of doubts, assignment introduction	Summarize key points, answer questions, explain assignment requirements	Ask final questions, note assignment details, complete evaluation form	Summary handout, assignment sheet, evaluation forms	Exit ticket: List 3 key postpartum assessments

ASSIGNMENT

Indicate whether the following statements are True (T) or False (F)

- 1) The normal duration of the puerperium is 6 weeks
- 2) Lochia rubra is the first type of lochia and appears bright red
- 3) The fundus should be at the level of the umbilicus immediately after delivery
- 4) Postpartum hemorrhage is defined as blood loss exceeding 500ml after vaginal delivery
- 5) Breastfeeding should be initiated within the first hour after birth when possible
- 6) The uterus involutes at a rate of approximately 1 cm per day
- 7) Postpartum blues typically occur within the first 2 weeks and resolve spontaneously
- 8) Active management of the third stage of labor helps prevent postpartum hemorrhage
- 9) Vital signs should be monitored every 15 minutes for the first hour postpartum
- 10) Perineal care should include warm water cleansing from front to back

FACILITATOR NOTES

- Ensure simulation mannequins are set up before class begins
- Prepare case study materials and distribute at appropriate time
- Have emergency protocol charts readily available for reference
- Monitor time carefully to ensure all activities are completed
- Be sensitive to students who may have personal experiences with childbirth
- Encourage questions throughout the session, not just at the end
- Have backup video clips ready in case of technical difficulties

EVALUATION / SUMMARY

- Students will complete a practical assessment demonstrating postpartum assessment skills
- Written quiz on postpartum complications and nursing interventions
- Group presentation on a postpartum case study analysis
- Self-reflection journal on learning experience and areas for improvement
- Peer evaluation of assessment technique during practice sessions

REFERENCES

- *World Health Organization (2013). WHO recommendations for the prevention and treatment of postpartum haemorrhage. Geneva: WHO Press.*
- *Cunningham, F.G., et al. (2022). Williams Obstetrics (26th ed.). New York: McGraw-Hill Education.*
- *Zambia Ministry of Health (2020). National Guidelines for Maternal and Neonatal Care. Lusaka: MOH.*
- *Royal College of Obstetricians and Gynaecologists (2016). Prevention and Management of Postpartum Haemorrhage. Green-top Guideline No. 52.*
- *Lusaka School of Nursing (2022). Integrated Reproductive Health II Module Curriculum.*
- *WHO Postpartum Care Guidelines (p.15) - Early assessment and intervention are critical for preventing maternal mortality*
- *Zambia MOH Maternal Care Standards (p.42) - All postpartum mothers should receive comprehensive assessment within 24 hours*